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DJIA 52218.58 ▼ 6.06 0.01% NASDAQ 25690.90 ▼ 0.6% STOXX 600 646.93 ▲ 0.6% 10-YR.TREAS. ▼ 7/32, yield 4.657% OIL \$86.83 ▲ \$2.49 GOLD \$4,146.90 ▲ \$75.80 EURO \$1.1412 YEN 163.15

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **IBM warned investors** that its full-year revenue growth will be lower than it had previously forecast one week after suffering its worst single-day stock loss when executives previewed disappointing results. **A1**
- ◆ **Google parent** Alphabet posted 24% revenue growth year-over-year for the second quarter, but concern over the company's heavy spending on AI infrastructure damped investors' enthusiasm. **B1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** fell, with the S&P 500 and the Nasdaq retreating 0.1% and 0.6%, respectively, and the Dow shedding less than 0.1%. **B11**
- ◆ **The U.K.'s rate of inflation** in June declined to its lowest level in more than a year after gasoline costs fell. **A7**
- ◆ **The EU approved** Paramount's \$81 billion bid to buy Warner Bros. Discovery after the companies offered concessions related to film distribution in Europe. **B3**
- ◆ **Airbus shares in Paris** rose 7% after the group said it aimed to significantly boost its profitability in the coming years from sales of commercial and military aircraft. **B3**
- ◆ **British digital bank** Revolut undertook a secondary share sale, increasing its valuation to \$115 billion from \$75 billion late last year. **B11**
- ◆ **OpenAI raised its** projected spending on computing power to around \$750 billion through 2030, up from an earlier projection of roughly \$600 billion. **B4**
- ◆ **AMD and Anthropic** signed a deal for tens of billions of dollars' worth of AI servers, supplying Anthropic with much-needed computing power. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The U.S. and Saudi Arabia** reached a landmark agreement to provide the kingdom with a civil nuclear program and potentially open the door to uranium enrichment on its territory. **A1**
- ◆ **The U.S. is surging** forces, medics and weaponry to the Middle East to give Trump more muscular military options as he considers expanding the conflict against Iran. **A1**
- ◆ **A federal judge** in New York scheduled the criminal trial of ousted Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro and his wife for June 2027. **A5**
- ◆ **Landlords filed** a lawsuit seeking to overturn the new rent freeze on New York City apartments, challenging Mayor Zohran Mamdani's signature campaign issue. **A3**
- ◆ **Mamdani appointed** former Federal Trade Commission Chair Lina Khan to lead New York City's Economic Development Corporation. **A3**
- ◆ **Anthropic doubled** its spending on the midterm elections to \$40 million in the midst of a ferocious debate about how to regulate the transformative technology. **A4**
- ◆ **French prosecutors** were investigating the death of a French modeling scout with ties to Jeffrey Epstein after he was found dead at his home outside Paris. **A8**
- ◆ **A Florida teen suing** social-media platforms over claims their design led to mental health issues dropped his lawsuit against Meta Platforms ahead of a trial slated to begin next week. **A3**
- ◆ **Died: James Woolsey**, 84, former CIA director. **A5**

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Soldiers Killed in the Mideast Come Home



TRIBUTE: President Trump and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth attended the transfer of the bodies of four soldiers killed in the Iran war in a ceremony at Dover, Del., on Wednesday. They salute as the coffin of Pvt. Isabella Gonzales is brought off a plane.

Surge of Forces Gives Trump Options to Escalate Iran War

Influx of troops, medics, weaponry comes after deadly strikes by Tehran

WASHINGTON—The U.S. is surging forces, medics and weaponry to the Middle East to give President Trump more muscular military options as he considers expanding the conflict against Iran, according to people familiar with the matter.

In the past week, special-

operations forces have deployed to the region from their U.S. bases, according to flight-tracking data and U.S. officials. Squadrons of jet fighters have been staged across the Middle East, and bomber aircraft at bases in the U.S. and U.K. are on high alert to ramp up operations, according to one of the officials.

Additionally, more than 150 medics have arrived at the Landstuhl Regional Medical

By Shelby Holliday, Lara Seligman and Stephen Kalin

Center in Germany in recent days, another official said. The hospital is the primary location for treating troops injured in combat in the Middle East.

The preparations are the latest indication that Trump is considering escalating the conflict after three U.S. soldiers were killed in an Iranian attack in Jordan in recent days. A fourth service member was killed in Iraq during a controlled detonation of an Iranian drone.

Retired Gen. Joseph Votel, the former commander of U.S. Central Command and U.S. Special Operations Command, said the surge itself doesn't necessarily mean major military operations are inevitable.

"The big idea here is to give the president and the secretary [of defense] the most

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- ◆ **Trump threatens Iranian infrastructure**..... A6
- ◆ **U.S. commercial crude oil stockpiles climb**..... B11

Retirement Accounts Get Supersized

More than 1,000 Americans racked up IRAs worth at least \$25 million

By ANNE TERGESEN AND THEO FRANCIS

The average American family has about \$268,300 in individual retirement accounts. Gregory Baszucki's holds at least \$68 million—and possibly a whole lot more.

Baszucki, 61 years old, is one of hundreds of people who bought stakes in promising startups when the shares were worth peanuts, stashing them in retirement accounts and watching their values balloon to eight figures or more. What they are getting, essentially, is the mother of all tax

breaks.

IRAs and workplace retirement accounts were created to help working Americans save for old age by providing tax incentives for doing so. The accounts have been supercharged by startup founders, hedge-fund managers and Silicon Valley insiders who have access to investment opportunities unavailable to most Americans.

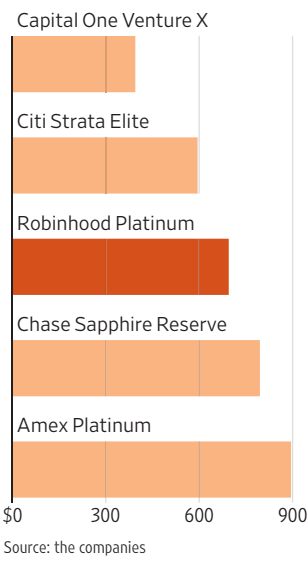
Those entrepreneurs and their financial backers are increasingly using that strategy to pile up giant retirement-account balances, all subsidized

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Robinhood Revises Card

Robinhood overhauled its \$695 platinum card after its perks drew complaints. **B1**

Annual fees



Source: the companies

IBM Cuts Outlook After Grim Warning

By ANISSA GARDIZY

IBM warned investors on Wednesday that its full-year revenue growth will be lower than it had previously forecast, one week after suffering its worst single-day stock loss in history when executives previewed disappointing results.

International Business Machines posted its second-quarter earnings Wednesday, confirming the results that it previewed last week in a rare move that erased about \$67 billion in stock-market value.

Big Blue's infrastructure revenue of \$3.8 billion was down 7% from a year earlier. That unit was pulled down by lower-than-expected sales of data-center mainframes,

which fell 42%.

IBM now expects full-year revenue growth to be in a range between 4% and 5%. Earlier this year, the company projected full-year growth of more than 5%.

Chief Executive Arvind Krishna said the company is in the "early innings of a structural shift for business."

Even so, he said he believes IBM is well-positioned across its software, infrastructure and consulting businesses to help customers capture value from artificial intelligence.

"With the portfolio we have and the opportunities ahead, it comes down to execution," Krishna told investors. "That is where we fell

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Fans Lose Themselves, Literally, At This Rapper's Concerts

* * *

Pitbull devotees flock to shows in bald caps.

It's fun until they lose track of their friends.

By JULIA MUNSLow

As a crowd of mostly women danced the night away at Pitbull's recent concert in London, barely a hair was out of place.

That's because fans of the man born Armando Christian Perez have an unofficial dress code at his shows that emulates the rapper's signature look: aviator sunglasses, a black tie and a white shirt, topped off with a bald cap.

"It's embarrassing if you don't come with one," Kirsty Downes, 35, said as several other Pitbull lookalikes strode through Hyde Park on the way to the show.

But as Downes and other

members of the bald-capped brigade often learn, loyalty can come at a price.

"You start walking off with the wrong Pitbull," said Downes. "I'm walking and I'm like, 'Oh, I'm with Denise, and no, I'm not, I'm with Dave. I don't know Dave.'"

Factor in the patchy phone service and getting lost is almost inevitable.

"We lost [our friend] Wendy like 5 minutes ago," said Rosie Floyd, 32, who was with her mother and friends at the show. "It's like, 'Which bald cap is our bald cap?'"

The bald-cap trend at Pitbull shows emerged after the

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Hairless leader

Japan's Prima Ballerina Remains En Pointe at 77

By JASON DOUGLAS AND JUNKO FUKUTOME

TOKYO—Yoko Morishita was 3 years old when she first put on a pair of ballet shoes. Seventy-five years later, she's still *en pointe*.

Morishita, who will turn 78 in December, is the prima ballerina in Japan's storied Matsuyama Ballet Company. One of Japan's most-celebrated dancers, she performed with Rudolf Nureyev 200 times and toured with Margot Fonteyn.

Today, she is the world's oldest ballerina still taking on demanding lead roles. In January, she starred as Odette and the black swan Odile in "Swan Lake" and in May she performed "Coppelia." She is rehearsing for her role as Clara in "The Nutcracker" in November, a part she has played for 45 years.

Being the principal dancer

of a renowned ballet company would be taxing for a dancer half her age. Few ballet stars make it past 40 before hanging up their pumps and switching to teaching, overcome by the immense physical, mental and artistic demands of the art form.

In an interview at Matsuyama's Tokyo studio, her legs swathed in pink woolen socks to keep them warm, Morishita said her secret is simple: She lives for ballet and rarely thinks beyond the next day's rehearsal or performance. "Once today is over, I think about tomorrow's lesson," she said. "Before I knew it, 75 years had passed."

Morishita was born in Hiroshima in 1948, three years after the city was obliterated by an atomic bomb. Its inhabitants were rebuilding but the scars remained: Her grandmother survived the blast but

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL

Are therapists to blame for the rise of adults cutting off their parents? **A9**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

Tesla's second-quarter revenue surged as spending on AI, robotics soared. **B1**